

Elyse Speaks

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EDUCATION

Brown University, Department of History of Art and Architecture, Ph.D., 2005
Brown University, Department of History of Art and Architecture, M.A., 2001
University of Notre Dame, *Magna Cum Laude*, English and Program of Liberal Studies double major, 1997

EMPLOYMENT AND TEACHING

University of Notre Dame, Department of Art, Art History and Design
Professor of the Practice, 2024-present
Associate Professor of the Practice, 2016-2024
Affiliate, Gender Studies, 2016-present
Affiliate, Institute for Race and Resilience, 2019-present
Fellow, Nanovic Institute for European Studies, 2016-present
Assistant Professor of the Practice, 2013-2016
Postdoctoral Fellow, Gender Studies, awarded 2010, 2011-13
Visiting Assistant Professor, 2007-09
Adjunct Professor, Spring 2007

McGill University, Department of Art History and Communication
Visiting Lecturer, 2005-06

PUBLICATIONS**Books:**

Women, Making, and Everyday Value in Contemporary Installation Art, Bloomsbury Visual Arts, (2025)

Articles:

"Material Reciprocities and Modernist Antagonisms: Chase-Riboud's *The Albino*," *Arts* (Spring 2024)

Guest Editor; Co-author, Introduction, Special Issue: "Topical Abstraction in Contemporary Sculpture," *Arts* (Spring 2024), (Introduction). With essays by Elise Archias, Tiffany Bidler-Johnson, Becky Bivens, Sarah Cowan, Catherine Spencer

"Marcia Tucker's Domestic Politics: Art and Craft in the 1990s," *The Journal of Modern Craft* 15:3 (2022): pp. 295-311

"Artistic Process and Domestic Labor in Liza Lou's *Kitchen*," *American Art* 35:2 (2021): pp. 102-23

"The Terms of Craft and Other Means of Making: Lee Bontecou's Hybrid Trajectory," *Art Journal* 71:4 (2012/2013): pp. 54-71. Selected for reprint, *Art Journal Open* (2024): <https://artjournal.collegeart.org/?p=3532>

"Space, Gender, Sculpture: Bourgeois, Nevelson, and the Changing Conditions of Sculpture in the 1950s," *Women's Studies: an interdisciplinary journal* 40:8 (2011): pp. 1052-1091

"Recasting sculptural function: use and misuse in the work of Bontecou, Bourgeois and Nevelson," *The Sculpture Journal* 19:2 (2010): pp. 187- 200

"'We Bring Our Lares With Us:' Bodies and Domiciles in the Sculpture of Louise Bourgeois," *Art Journal* 68:3 (2009): pp. 88-103

"Experiencing Louise Nevelson's *Moon Garden*," *American Art* 21:2 (2007): pp. 96-108

Chapters in Books:

"Gender and Maternity in Barbara Chase-Riboud's Early Sculpture," Routledge Companion to Art History and Feminisms, ed. Erin Silver (forthcoming, Routledge, 2026)

"Thin Art: Karla Black's Pretenses," Karla Black: 20 Years, ed. Alison Ferris; with contributions by Elizabeth Smith and Jenni Sorkin (Des Moines Art Center, 2020), pp. 85-97

"The Culture of Collecting," In Focus: Black Wall 1959 by Louise Nevelson, ed. Alex Taylor, Tate Research Publication, (2016) <http://www.tate.org.uk/research/publications/in-focus/black-wall-louise-nevelson/culture-of-collecting>. Accessed 9 September 2016

"Sloppy craft as temporal drag in the work of Josh Faught," with Elissa Auther, in Sloppy Craft: Post-Disciplinarity and the Crafts, ed. Elaine Cheasley Paterson and Susan Surette (London: Bloomsbury, 2015), pp. 45-59

"The transparent signifier: Hirst, invisibility, and critique," in Sculpture and the Vitrine, ed., John Welchman (London: Bloomsbury, 2013), pp. 231-250

Reviews and Other Publications:

"Nevelson's Everyday Environments," in Louise Nevelson: Mrs. N's Palace. Exhibition catalogue, ed. Anne Horvath (Centre Pompidou-Metz, 2025), Forthcoming

"Ich-Du" and "Urd-Werdandi Skuld-die Noren" in *Anselm Kiefer: Opus Magnum*, ed. Fergus McCaffrey (Fergus McCaffrey, 2024), 48-51 and 88-91.

"The Poetics of Relation: Lea Goldberg and Sarah Martin," *Conversations Series*, South Bend Museum of Art (July 2020).

"Obituary: Louise Bourgeois," *The Sculpture Journal* 19:2 (2010): pp. 244- 248.

Childsplay: The Art of Allan Kaprow by Jeff Kelley; forward by David Antin, Berkeley, Los Angeles and London: University of California Press, 2004. *Art History* 29:1 (2006): pp. 190-93.

SELECT CONFERENCES AND LECTURES

SECAC, Speaker, "Weaving the Cultural Character of Landscape: Maren Hassinger and the Language of Infrastructure," Panel, Women of Earth Art: Nature, Gender, and Race During the Long 1970s (October 2025)

College Art Association, Speaker "Weaving the Cultural Character of Landscape," Panel, "Moving Out: David Smith and the Outdoor Migration of Sculpture," (February, 2025)

CIHA, Matter/Materiality, Speaker, "Barbara Chase Riboud's *The Albino*," Panel, "Bodies that Matter," (June, 2024)

College Art Association, Speaker, "Material Reciprocities and the Reinvention of Sculptural Tradition," Panel, "Black Pasts-Black Futures," (February, 2024)

Feminist Art History Conference, Panel Moderator, "Objects and Agency," American University (September, 2023)

Works on the Floor Symposium, Speaker, "Process, Site, and Entanglement in the Work of Maren Hassinger," Yale Center for British Art (2022)

Southeast College Art Conference; Chair, "Topical Abstraction: race, materials, process," MICA, Baltimore (2022)

Association for the Study of the Arts of the Present, Session Co-chair, "Sculptural Reciprocities" online (2021)

Association for the Study of the Arts of the Present, Speaker "Material Reciprocity as Sculptural Fiction," Chicago, (2021)

Feminist Art History Conference, Speaker, "Glue-Gun Wielding Groupies: Sarah Sze and Martha Stewart," American University, Washington D.C. (2020, postponed to 2021)

Association of Art Historians Conference, Speaker "Marcia Tucker's Domestic Politics: Art and Craft in the 1990s," University of Birmingham, U.K. (2021)

College Art Association, Chair. "Marking Time," Chicago (2020)

American Art and Visual Culture Seminar Series, Speaker, "'A Labor of Love': the museum, the kitchen, and the politics of labor," Newberry Library, Chicago (2019)

Materializing Resistance: Gender, Politics, and Craft, Speaker, "The Politics of Process," Conference, University of Kentucky (2019)

Gender Studies Colloquium Series, Speaker "'Housewife Beads the World!' Liza Lou and the Politics of Process," University of Notre Dame (2019)

Feminist Art History Conference, Speaker, "A Labor of Love and the Politics of Process," American University, Washington, D.C. (2018)

Contemporary art and the Politics of Process, Conference co-chair and organizer, University of Notre Dame in England, London (2018)

Contemporary art and the Politics of Process, Speaker "Everyday Labors and the Politics of Process," University of Notre Dame in England, London (2018)

Narrating Home through an East/West Divide, "Everyday Labors: the domestic politics of the bead," Conference, Stockholm, (2018)

Southeast College Art Conference, "Sensing Everyday Labors," Ohio State University, Columbus, (2017).

College Art Association, Session Chair, "Housework: Contemporary art and the domestic," Washington D.C. (2016)

Southeast College Art Conference, Speaker, "Karla Black's material play," Sarasota (2014)

College Art Association, Speaker, "Portraits of an Artist: Picturing Lee Bontecou and Her Studio," Chicago (2014)

At Play in the Space Between: Literature and Culture, 1914-1945, The Space Between Society, Speaker, "Hobbies, art, and play: the subversion of productivity in modern American aesthetics," Chicago (2013)

College Art Association Conference, Speaker, "Dissolution, disillusion, and deflation: Damien Hirst's double act," New York (2011)

Gender, Place and Space Conference, Speaker, "Spatial contradiction and the gender of sculpture in the 1950s and 1960s," University of Notre Dame (2010)

Revisiting the Art and Craft Divide Conference, Speaker, "Craft, legibility, and the critical purchase of Lee Bontecou's handmade machines," Sacramento State University (2010)

Sculpture in the Vitrine, Conference, Speaker, "The transparent signifier: Hirst, invisibility, and critique," Henry Moore Institute, Leeds, U.K. (2009)

Abstraction in the Public Sphere: New Approaches; Conference co-organizer with keynote speakers including Nan Rosenthal and Mary Miss, University of Notre Dame (2009)

SELECT GRANTS AND SPONSORED PROGRAMS

American Philosophical Society, Franklin Research Grant Recipient (2025)

Institute for Scholarship in the Liberal Arts, Notre Dame Research Grant (2025, 2024, 2023).

Office of International Studies, University of Notre Dame, London Global Gateway Research Grant (2021).

Institute for Scholarship in the Liberal Arts, Notre Dame Mid-Size Teaching Beyond the Classroom Grant (2024, 2023, 2021).

Teaching Beyond the Classroom grant (2022, 2021, 2019, 2018, 2017, 2016, 2015, 2014, 2012).

Mid-Size Research Grant (2019, 2018, 2017, 2015).

Henkels Small Grant (2017).

Nanovic Institute for European Studies, Research and Travel Grant (2024, 2021, 2020).

Conference Grant (2017).

Office of Research, University of Notre Dame Kobayashi Travel Grant (2018, 2017).

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Grant Reviewer, American Philosophical Society (2019-24)

External reviewer for tenure and promotion cases, details provided upon request

Manuscript reviewer: American Art, Archives of American Art Journal, Art Journal, The Journal of Modern Craft, Fashion Theory, Nierika, The Polish Journal of Aesthetics

STUDENT ADVISING AND RESEARCH

Notre Dame does not have a graduate program in Art History

MFA Thesis committee (2022-25; 2020-21; 2009-10)

Undergraduate thesis advisor:

Xiyun Wu, in progress (2024-25)

Clare Barloon, "Slow Violence in the Ecocritical work of Cecilia Vicuña and Minia Biabiani," (2023-24)

Willoughby Thom, "Social Surrealism and the 'Extra-Aesthetic' in the Practice of Jeremy Deller," (2022-23)

Meg Burns, "To Fund the Struggle: Theaster Gates and Systemic Practice," (2020-21; Riley Prize in Art History Recipient)

Katherine Coogan, "A.I.R. Gallery: A Case Study of The Cooperative, Non-profit Gallery as An Entity for the Empowerment of Women Artists" (2020-21)

Cameron Sumner, "Learning from Purifoy: Race, Assemblage, and Community-based Practice" (2020-21)

Caroline Cox, "A New Frontier: Artistic Approaches to Race and Land(scape) in the Historical Memory of America," (2019-20)

Sarah Harper, "Control and the Extra-Occident: Kader Attia and the Museum of Emotion," (2019-20)

Rachel Mills, "Museum Structures and the Politics of Display in the Installations of Fred Wilson," (2019-20)

Gracie Reyes "Decoration and Abstraction in the work of Tawney, Hicks, and Schapiro" (2017)

Louise Gallagher, The Identity Politics of a Muslim Woman, as told through select photographic series by Shirin Neshat" (2016-17)

Elena Gacek, "The Making of Mourning: Organic Materials in the work of Doris Salcedo." (2015-16; Riley Prize in Art History Recipient)

Helen Zhang (2015-16), Marybeth Train, (2011-12), Elizabeth Lee, (2007-8)